

South Carolina is a vibrant southeastern U.S. state covering 32,020 square miles with a diverse geography stretching from the Blue Ridge Mountains down to 187 miles of Atlantic coastline. Its highest peak is Sassafras Mountain at 3,560 feet, while the rest of the terrain features rolling Piedmont hills, sandy ridges, and a subtropical climate marked by warm summers and mild winters.

Nicknamed the Palmetto State, South Carolina holds a pivotal place in American history as one of the original 13 colonies and the first state to secede from the Union before the Civil War began at Fort Sumter.

Today, the state supports an estimated population of 5.5 million people across 46 counties. Columbia operates as the central capital, while Charleston and Greenville drive major commerce and culture. The modern economy relies heavily on international manufacturing, aerospace, automotive production, and a powerful tourism sector that attracts millions of annual visitors to coastal destinations like Myrtle Beach and Hilton Head Island.

Historic & Coastal Charm

- **Historic Downtown Charleston:** Known for its beautifully preserved architecture, cobblestone streets, and horse-drawn carriages. Top highlights include the vibrant houses of Rainbow Row, the historic Battery promenade overlooking the harbor, and the bustling Charleston City Market.
- **Fort Sumter National Monument:** Located in Charleston Harbor, this historic sea fort is famous as the site where the first shots of the American Civil War were fired in 1861. It is accessible to the public via tour boats.
- **Hilton Head Island:** A relaxed resort destination famous for its 12 miles of wide, sandy Atlantic beaches, world-class golf courses, and miles of shaded bike paths. The iconic red-and-white striped Harbour Town Lighthouse is a must-see.



Beach & Family Entertainment

- **Myrtle Beach Boardwalk & Promenade:** The lively centerpiece of the Grand Strand, a massive 60-mile stretch of continuous beach. The area is packed with oceanfront restaurants, souvenir shops, arcades, and the 187-foot-tall Myrtle Beach SkyWheel.
- **Brookgreen Gardens:** Located just south of Myrtle Beach in Murrells Inlet, this expansive 9,100-acre property combines a massive outdoor figurative sculpture garden, pristine botanical gardens, and a lowcountry zoo.

Mountains, Waterfalls & Forests

- **Falls Park on the Reedy:** A stunning urban oasis located right in the middle of downtown Greenville. It features beautifully landscaped gardens, scenic waterfalls, and the Liberty Bridge—a curved pedestrian suspension bridge offering great views of the river.
- **Congaree National Park:** Situated near the capital city of Columbia, this park preserves the largest remaining tract of old-growth bottomland hardwood forest in the southeastern United States. A 2.6-mile elevated boardwalk makes it easy to explore the swampy terrain.
- **Caesars Head State Park:** Located in the Blue Ridge Mountains near the North Carolina border, this park offers a dramatic overlook platform with panoramic views from 3,200 feet above sea level. It is also the trailhead for a popular hike to Raven Cliff Falls, a 420-foot waterfall.